

Skullcandy EcoBuds

Budget and environment friendly TWS

Skullcandy's Ecobuds stand out in the competitive world of true wireless earbuds, mainly for their environmental angle. Using 100 per cent recycled plastics in both the earbuds and case, Skullcandy positions the Ecobuds as a sustainable choice for users. But do they live up to the performance standards of the best in their class, or is the eco-friendly appeal just a cover for lacklustre quality? Let's dive into their design, performance, sound quality, and value proposition to see if they deserve a spot in your audio lineup.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Right from the first look, the Skullcandy Ecobuds emphasise their commitment to sustainability. Crafted from recycled materials, they don't exactly pop with bold visuals or cutting-edge aesthetics, but their understated matte finish and compact design do have a subtle charm. The build feels solid enough, though there's a noticeable lightness to them, likely due to the use of lightweight materials. They're comfortable to wear, sitting securely in the ear without putting much pressure. However, unlike some sportier options in this range, they lack ear wings, which can make them feel less stable during vigorous activity.

The Ecobuds carry an IPX4 rating, meaning they're somewhat resistant to dust and water but far from indestructible. They'll withstand light rain or sweaty gym sessions, but they might not be the best choice for extreme outdoor conditions. For most users who are environmentally conscious and don't expect heavy-duty performance, this durability level should be sufficient.



FEATURES

Skullcandy has taken a no-nonsense approach to features here, offering what most users need without any frills. The Ecobuds notably lack active noise cancellation, which has become almost a given at this price point. While the lack of ANC is a bit disappointing, the snug fit does create a reasonable level of passive noise isolation that will suffice for moderate ambient noise. Those looking to block out loud environments, however, might want to consider other options.

A unique selling point here is the Tile integration, allowing users to track their earbuds using the Tile app if they go missing. It's a genuinely helpful feature, especially for those who tend to misplace small items frequently. The touch controls on the Ecobuds are straightforward and responsive for basic operations like play/pause, volume adjustment, and

answering calls, though there are no customisation options for users seeking a tailored experience.

Another one of the biggest highlights of these earbuds is that you can charge them directly from your phone. The built-in USB-C cable is a nifty addition for those who are running out of charge on the go or forgetting their cables back home all the time.

The Ecobuds come with Bluetooth 5.2, which provides a stable connection and fast pairing. Within a typical 10-meter range, the connection holds well, with minimal dropouts. They support mono mode, so you can use one earbud independently, which is helpful for calls or ambient listening.

That said, the Ecobuds only support the standard SBC codec, which is a limitation compared to competitors offering aptX or AAC. Most casual listeners won't notice much difference, but for those who prioritise higher sound quality, particularly when streaming high-res music, this codec limitation might be noticeable.

PERFORMANCE

Skullcandy is known for its bass-forward sound signature, and the Ecobuds follow this tradition. These earbuds deliver a warm sound profile that puts emphasis on low frequencies while keeping the mids and highs reasonably clear. Let's break down each frequency range:

- 1. Low Frequencies (Bass):** The bass here is punchy and well-defined, with a strong sub-bass presence (from around 60 Hz to 100 Hz). For bass-heavy genres like hip-hop or EDM, this tuning offers an engaging, full-bodied listening experience. The bass is elevated, but it doesn't completely overpower other frequencies, which is a delicate balance that Skullcandy has managed well here. Overall, it's a satisfying bass performance for casual listeners, although purists might find it a bit too forward.
- 2. Mid Frequencies (Mids):** The mid-range is clear but slightly recessed, making vocals and instruments